

10 Essential Free VST Plugins

Every Beginner Music Producer Should Install

Build your music production toolkit without spending a dollar.

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Introduction

Music production has never been more accessible than it is today. Thanks to generous developers around the world, there are now incredible free VST plugins that rival many paid tools.

In this guide you'll discover 10 essential plugins that can help you build a powerful music production setup without spending money.

These plugins work in most major DAWs including:

- Ableton Live
- FL Studio

- Logic Pro
- Cubase
- Reaper
- Studio One

1. Vital

Vital is one of the most powerful free wavetable synthesizers available today. It offers incredible sound design capabilities with an intuitive visual interface.

- Advanced wavetable synthesis
- Drag-and-drop modulation
- Beautiful modern interface
- Huge preset libraries

Website: <https://vital.audio>

2. Spitfire LABS

LABS is a collection of beautifully recorded instruments created by Spitfire Audio. These sounds are perfect for cinematic, ambient and emotional music.

- Soft Piano
- Strings
- Choirs
- Atmospheric pads

Website: <https://labs.spitfireaudio.com>

3. Valhalla Supermassive

A legendary free reverb and delay plugin known for massive atmospheric sounds. It is widely used by professional producers.

- Huge reverbs

- Cosmic delays
- Beautiful presets
- Low CPU usage

Website: <https://valhalladsp.com>

4. Surge XT

Surge XT is an open-source synthesizer with powerful sound design capabilities including multiple synthesis engines.

- Wavetable synthesis
- FM synthesis
- Subtractive synthesis
- Extensive modulation options

Website: <https://surge-synthesizer.github.io>

5. Dexed

Dexed recreates the legendary Yamaha DX7 synthesizer which defined many classic 80s sounds.

- Authentic FM synthesis
- Electric pianos
- Bells and plucks
- Thousands of presets available

Website: <https://asb2m10.github.io/dexed>

6. TAL Reverb 4

A vintage-style reverb plugin that adds warmth and character to mixes.

- Simple interface
- Classic reverb sound
- Low CPU usage

Website: <https://tal-software.com>

7. Ample Guitar M Lite II

A realistic acoustic guitar instrument with detailed sampling and natural playing styles.

Website: <https://www.amplesound.net>

8. OTT

OTT is a famous multiband compressor used heavily in EDM and electronic music production.

Website: <https://xferrecords.com>

9. Tyrell N6

An analog-style synthesizer created by u-he that produces warm vintage sounds.

Website: <https://u-he.com>

10. MT Power Drum Kit

A realistic drum instrument with built-in grooves that makes it easy to create drum tracks quickly.

Website: <https://www.powerdrumkit.com>

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